Kaylani Rivera

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Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign Expected May 2027

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science with a Minor in Game Studies & Design *GPA: 3.8/4.0*

- Relevant coursework: Interactive Computer Graphics, Game Development, Data Structures, Systems Programming, Algorithms & Models of Computation, Computer Architecture, Programming Languages & Compilers
- Honors: Dean's List, James Scholar, Legacy Learning & Service Scholarship, State Farm Computer Science Scholarship
- Campus Involvement: ACM@UIUC (Infrastructure Chair & Social Lead), HackIllinois (Co-Director), BUILT by Colorstack (Social Director), Adventure Club (Membership Director), Women in Computer Science (social team)

Work Experience

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign August 2026 – Present

Course Assistant, CS 415: Game Development *Urbana, IL*

- Support **hundreds of students** developing games in Unreal Engine by troubleshooting technical, gameplay, and design challenges through office hours and individual guidance
- Evaluate student projects and provide actionable feedback on technical implementation, functionality, and UI/UX design
- Collaborate with course staff to identify recurring student challenges and learning gaps, informing exam questions, course improvements, and grading standards

Goldman Sachs June 2026 – August 2026

Summer Analyst – Controllers Software Engineering Intern *New York, NY*

- Built a Kafka-based Java pipeline to consolidate **hundreds** of financial exception calculations into a few batch operations, reducing alert volume **from hundreds to single digits** during downstream service outages
- Automated the quarterly regulatory fund scoping process with AI to consolidate data from multiple sources and processes into a single workflow, increasing reporting efficiency and accuracy
- Coordinated cross-functional teams through Kafka provisioning and security approval to unblock critical CI/CD deployments

Girls Who Code June 2025 – Aug 2025 & May 2024 – Aug 2024

Lead Teaching Assistant *Remote*

- Taught programming and game development concepts through interactive daily lessons in p5.js to **300+** high school students, adapting the curriculum to match student needs and achieving **94%** project completion
- Mentored students through check-ins, feedback, and collaborative sessions to improve retention, confidence, and engagement

Leadership Experience

Association for Computing Machinery (ACM) @ UIUC September 2024 – January 2026

Infrastructure Chair *Urbana, IL*

- Led development of ACM's internal management platform serving **1,000+** members, translating organizational needs into product improvements and achieving **99.9%** uptime using React, TypeScript, and AWS Lambda
- Gathered member feedback to identify usability improvements and led UX redesigns in collaboration with developers, increasing resource engagement by **26%** and active membership by **14%**
- Established Agile/Scrum and CI/CD processes across seven teams, improving coordination and streamlining release cycles

HackIllinois October 2023 – September 2024

Co-Director *Urbana, IL*

- Led **50+** staff members in planning and executing the Midwest's largest student-run hackathon, serving **800+** participants
- Established weekly roadmap reviews and cross-team meetings to improve alignment and accelerate milestone completion
- Managed event budget, logistics, and corporate partnerships, leading to a **53%** increase in sponsorship prizes

Projects

Gamify – Frontend Developer & PM Java, HTML, CSS, TypeScript, Node.js, and Vue.js

- Designed and developed a productivity web app that uses gamification to encourage consistent task completion
- Built a dynamic achievement-tracking system with real-time progress updates and rewards to support user engagement
- Managed project milestones, task delegation, and feature integration across the development process

Recipe Sorter – Fullstack Developer HTML, CSS, and JavaScript

- Built a data-driven recipe management platform focused on improving organization through real-time search and filtering
- Implemented dynamic filtering and sorting functionality based on user feedback, improving usability and personalization
- Automated data synchronization with Google Apps Script, eliminating manual updates and reducing maintenance overhead

Skills

Technical: Python, C/C++, Java, HTML/CSS, JavaScript, p5.js, Numpy, Pandas, SciPy, Matplotlib

Tools: Jira, Confluence, Git/GitHub, VS Code, IntelliJ, Docker, Notion, Canva, Figma, Unreal Engine, Unity, Devin, Excel, LaTex